

PROPOSAL

Special Campaign for Disposal of Pending Matters Project Monitoring Unit at DARPG - Extension



QUALITY COUNCIL OF INDIA

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INTRODUCTION

The Honorable Prime Minister directed all government departments to look at all existing procedures and processes and scrap unnecessary paperwork and compliances. To this effect, a Special Campaign for Disposal of Pending Matters (SCDPM) had been undertaken for the month of October 2021. The success of the campaign led to continuation and institutionalization of the campaign for the Central Secretariat. Timely and effective disposal of public grievances, references from MPs and State Governments, inter-ministerial consultations, parliamentary assurances etc. is an important part of the work of Departments and Ministries

The Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG), is the nodal agency of the Government of India in-charge of policy making, monitoring and coordinating departments for public grievances and administrative reforms. The Allocation of Business Rules, 1961 delineated the mandate for the same.

Quality Council of India has worked very closely with DARPG on previous occasions and is familiar with its working and areas of concerns. We started our journey together by conducting numerous grievance studies. QCI also conducted two independent impact evaluation through a Swachhata Assessment of the SCDPM in November 2021 & May 2022 respectively and submitted a report focusing on the notable initiatives and the best practices across ministries/departments. Thus, QCI has closely worked with the nodal officers of all the ministries/departments and has working knowledge of the SCDPM Portal. For purpose of constant monitoring of all the Ministries/Departments and publication of monthly reports highlighting pendency trends and best practices of the Special Campaign, a 3 member PMU on Special Campaign was setup by QCI at DARPG for 6 months in August 2022.

The PMU assisted DARPG in the preparation and release of monthly reports on Secretariat Reforms, highlighting progress in the Swachhata Campaign & Reducing Pendency, Increasing Efficiency in Decision Making, and e-Office implementation in the Central Secretariat. The PMU coordinates with nodal officers of all the Ministries/departments through DARPG's portal. The team also assisted in the conduct and assessment report of 'Special Campaign 2.0 & 3.0' in October 2022 &

2023. The Special Campaign 3.0 covered more than 2.58 lac office sites. The Campaign found its mention in the 105th episode of Mann Ki Baat and PMO Twitter handle along with prominent national and regional media.

The assessment report on ‘Special Campaign 3.0’ was released by Hon’ble MoS (PP) during Good Governance Week 2023. The Hon’ble MoS (PP) appreciated the reduction in pendency in the Central Secretariat and institutionalization of Swacchata through the adoption of a saturation approach to cover the field offices across the country and highlighted that the momentum of the Campaign should be maintained in the coming year and become a way of life. In pursuant to the Hon’ble MoS PP’s directions, DARPG issued an OM on ‘Reducing Pendency Matters to the Minimum Possible in Government’ dated 27.12.2023 for the continuation of the campaign in all the Ministries/Departments.

For constant monitoring of the Campaign and assisting DARPG in its key monthly publications, the PMU has continuously received its extension, and the last work order was valid till 30th September, 2024.

The PMU is currently assisting DARPG with the preparation of the monthly report on Secretariat Reforms to also cover key insights from the e-Office analytics Dashboard. A dedicated chapter on best practices, deeper analysis of Swacchata parameters and performance of all Ministries/Departments on various eOffice parameters including average transaction level of file movement to monitor delayering has been introduced in the monthly reports. For effective planning and coordination of the campaign and generation of subsequent reports, QCI proposes to extend the PMU up to 31st March, 2025.

I. About Quality Council of India

The Quality Council of India (QCI) has been set up as a non-profit autonomous society registered under Societies Registration Act XXI of 1860 to establish an accreditation structure in the country and to spread quality movement in India by undertaking a National Quality Campaign.

QCI was established as the National body for Accreditation on recommendations of Expert Mission of EU after consultations in Inter-Ministerial Task Force, Committee of Secretaries and Group of Ministers and finally a Cabinet decision in 1996. Accordingly, the Council was made an autonomous non-profit organization through seed funding initially by the Government of India and the Indian Industry represented by the three premier industry associations, Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM), Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) and Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI). The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry is the nodal point for all matters connected with Quality and QCI.

The Chairman of QCI is nominated by the Prime Minister. QCI was envisaged as an independent organization with its own source of funds through accreditation and activities of quality promotion. It receives limited plan funds for specific promotional activities in quality domain.

The Council was established to create a mechanism for third-party assessment of products, services and processes. In tune with the international best practices, it was envisaged that the Council will play the role of the National Accreditation Body (NAB) as per existing eco-system of quality around the world and will ensure that the quality of life of citizens around the world is improved. It was therefore, befitting that the Council was organized as an independent organization from both government and Industry and functions as an Independent Professional body with its own rules, powers and functions strictly as per the MoA of the society.

II. Objective

The overall objective of setting up the PMU will be to work in association with the DARPG to provide strategy and monitoring consultation for the Special Campaign for Disposal of Pending Matters (SCDPM). The PMU will achieve this by being the nodal point for planning and working on actionable agendas as prioritized by the Department.

III. Scope of Work

Professionals working in the PMU will primarily work within the Department on monitoring, data analytics, and drawing insights vis-a-vis SCDPM. The scope of work includes:

- a.** Monitoring of the SCDPM Portal and coordination with nodal officers
- b.** Data Analytics on the data received on the SCDPM Portal
- c.** Drafting agenda for the monthly review meeting of all the Ministries/Departments by DARPG
- d.** Preparation of presentations or reports on the update and progress of the Ministries/Departments on SCDPM
- e.** Preparation of Assessment report and presentations for Special Campaign
- f.** Insights on e-Office Analytics for the monthly report via Dashboard and coordination with NIC
- g.** Detailed chapter on Best Practices, In-focus Ministry/Department, deeper analysis of average transaction levels and eOffice parameters.

The complete scope, along with milestones, can be finalized by mutual agreement between the DARPG and QCI.

The key deliverables of the PMU since August 2022 include:

- ✓ Monthly Report on ‘Secretariat Reforms’ highlighting the progress of the Central Secretariat in Swachhata, Pendency, Initiatives for Increasing Efficiency, and eOffice analytics
- ✓ Special Campaign 2.0 & 3.0 report highlighting progress under the nationwide campaign for minimizing pendency and institutionalizing Swachhata
- ✓ Social Media analytics for Special Campaign 3.0

- ✓ Coordination with Ministries/Departments in the Central Secretariat to report their best practices from across the Country
- ✓ Coordination with Ministries/Departments and NIC for monthly data updation on the portal
- ✓ Flyer and Tweets for the monthly publications
- ✓ Visit to Ministries/Departments to include a dedicated chapter on their achievements and initiatives
- ✓ Deeper analysis of various e-office parameters and transaction levels of files to monitor implementation of Delaying

IV. Composition and Manpower

The PMU team will comprise 3 QCI professionals. The team will be working with DARPG for a period of 6 months, from 1st October, 2024 to 31st March, 2025. The Department will assign a Single Point of Contact (SPOC) for smooth coordination on project requirements.

The professionals will have the relevant qualifications and professional background required to fulfil the tasks outlined in the previous section.

These professionals shall have the following skills and credentials

- a. The Project lead shall have a direct line of reporting to Chairman and Secretary General, QCI
- b. The professionals might have been a part of any earlier PMU's set up at various Ministries/ Departments by QCI
- c. To provide assistance with specific analysis, at least 1 professional should have core expertise in data analytics and must have graduated from Tier 1 college from India/ abroad

Apart from the above mentioned points, DARPG may ask for professionals with certain skills they deem necessary. This intimation should be done before signing of the work order by both the parties

V. Review

A monthly review may be conducted for the PMU. The composition of the review panel may be decided by the DARPG. The broad role of the review panel may be as follows:

- a. Conduct monthly progress reviews for the 3 QCI professionals
- b. The review panel may choose to re-focus the QCI team onto a different part of the pre-agreed upon scope if they feel it might add more value. The panel and the QCI team may mutually agree upon the revised direction for the project
- c. Debottlenecking of any major hurdles faced during the project

VI. Financials

The financials for executing the diagnostic are listed below on a ‘man-days per activity’ basis. Additionally, the cost includes all major activities required to conduct the program along with administration costs of executing the program (print outs, logistics etc.).

Special Campaign for Disposal of Pendency Matters Project Monitoring Unit				
Quality Council of India				
Activity	Days	Number of Resources	Cost / Man Day	Total Cost
QCI Professionals	120	3	Rs. 7,500	Rs. 27,00,000
QCI (Administration Cost)	12% of total cost			Rs. 3,24,600
Total				Rs. 30,24,600

**GST as applicable shall be charged extra.*

VII. Payment Structure

The payment structure may be as follows:

S. No.	Target, Milestone, or Reporting Deliverables	Amount (%)
1.	Award of Work-Order and commencement of work	25%
2.	Completion of 3 months	25%
3.	Completion of 6 months	50%
4.	Total Amount	100%

VIII. Obligations and asks from the DARPG

To ensure the program starts and progresses smoothly, QCI requests the DARPG to facilitate the QCI team with the following:

- a. Issue a sanction order to QCI with the following aspects:
 - i. Finalised terms of payment
 - ii. Detailed work order to include final cost accepted by the DARPG
 - iii. Details of Initiatives and projects to be covered by the PMU
 - iv. Finalisation of the PMU's overall statement of work
- b. Creation of review committee, including finalisation of structure, powers and personnel on the committee
- c. Nominate a Single Point of Contact (SPOC) for various functions in DARPG for coordination with PMU to assist in cross-functional collaboration. Finalization of initiative scope to be done between QCI team and relevant SPOC before the start of the project
- d. In addition, a note is to be sent to all relevant stakeholders stating QCI's involvement to ensure cooperation
- e. Provision of 1 room within DARPG premises for project team members from QCI to sit. The room should have adequate seating for all QCI personnel and DARPG personnel deputed within the PMU. Printing, Wi-Fi and other facilities necessary should also be provided to the PMU team by the DARPG.
- f. Entry-pass for all project team members for the duration of project to be issued

IX. Terms and Conditions

1. Exit Clause

In case either party does not wish to continue with the project, expenses and project payment till date of continuation will be paid to Quality Council of India. The finalized exit route will be decided upon to finalize handover of responsibilities. Official termination of services will be brought into effect 3 weeks from notification of exit.

2. Dispute Resolution

Any dispute will be resolved by mutual agreement.

X. Undertakings

1. Data Confidentiality

QCI will ensure data confidentiality of all data, presentations, reports etc. prepared during the project and will not release the above to any other QCI team members except the three professionals engaged with the DARPG as well as any 3rd parties until prior discussion and agreement with the DARPG.

2. Payment

DARPG will ensure all required payments and reimbursements to Quality Council of India will be made in a timely manner.

3. Service Charge

Service charges (as applicable) will be paid by the DARPG in addition to the cost specified in the proposal above.